

TAREK MOHAMMAD ZIAD

Head of Information Technology | IT Manager | IT Service Management

Digital Transformation | Enterprise Technology | Cybersecurity Governance | AI & Data Analytics | Cloud & FinOps
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Professional Summary

IT leader with over 15 years running enterprise technology, cybersecurity, cloud, and ERP programs across education, retail, food & beverage, construction, and professional services. Owns IT budgets and vendor relationships, and has a track record of turning technology spend into results the business actually notices. Right now that means enterprise IT operations, service delivery, cybersecurity, and data governance for over 4,000 students and 500 employees, with a 13-person team reporting in. Builds toward Zero Trust and ISO 27001/NIST-aligned environments, and increasingly uses AI and automation to get decisions made faster.

Core Competencies

Leadership & Strategy: IT Strategy | Service Delivery Leadership | IT Budget & Vendor Management | Digital Transformation | Change Management | Team Leadership & Mentoring

IT Service Management: ITSM (ITIL Framework) | Incident, Problem & Change Management | SLA/OLA Management | Service Desk Operations | Workflow Automation

Cybersecurity & Risk: Cybersecurity Governance | Zero Trust Architecture | IAM & MFA | Endpoint Protection & SIEM Monitoring | NIST / ISO 27001-Aligned Controls | Business Continuity & Disaster Recovery | Backup Policy & RTO/RPO Planning

Cloud & Infrastructure: Cloud Migration (Oracle Cloud, AWS, Azure) | FinOps & Cloud Cost Optimization | Enterprise Networking | Virtualization | Windows Server & Active Directory

Data, AI & Applications: Data Governance & Compliance (PDPL-aligned) | Power BI & Executive Dashboards | Generative AI / AI Automation | ERP (Oracle, Odoo, SAP B1) | Predictive Analytics

Professional Experience

Head of Information Technology - Delta Education & Training Co. / Delta Maintenance and Cleaning

Riyadh, Saudi Arabia | Oct 2022 - Present

- Lead and mentor a 13-person IT team, with end-to-end ownership of infrastructure, applications, cybersecurity, budget planning, and vendor contracts.
- Renegotiated vendor contracts, right-sized infrastructure, and tightened technology governance across the board - cut annual IT operating costs by 25%.
- Rebuilt the IT service delivery workflow and automated the manual steps. Average response time went from 48 hours down to under an hour - a 98% improvement.
- Rolled out MFA, IAM, endpoint protection, and SIEM-based monitoring, moving the organization toward a Zero Trust posture aligned with NIST and ISO 27001 principles.
- Modernized cloud platforms, servers, storage, and network architecture to keep pace with day-to-day operations.
- Set RTO/RPO targets with executive leadership based on budget and risk tolerance, formalized the backup policy, and built PDPL-aligned data governance and BCP/DR practices where none existed before - with restoration testing and daily backup accountability baked in from day one.
- Designed the executive Power BI dashboards leadership now uses for day-to-day decisions - most of that data used to live in disconnected spreadsheets.
- Introduced AI-driven automation into IT service management, taking a real bite out of the manual, repetitive work that used to eat up the team's time.

IT Manager - Dar Assalam Education

Riyadh, Saudi Arabia | Nov 2020 - Nov 2022

- Redesigned the infrastructure and modernized servers and network architecture - system uptime improved by roughly 50%.
- Tightened the security baseline with endpoint protection, access controls, and ongoing monitoring, which noticeably shortened incident response times.
- Led the LMS rollout end to end, from training through change management. Adoption climbed 90% as a result.
- Ran over 35 workshops for more than 300 teachers and staff to get everyone comfortable with the new systems.

Project & Pre-Sales Manager - Open Technology (Tamkeen HR)

Riyadh, Saudi Arabia | Nov 2019 - Jun 2020

- Delivered a full Odoo ERP implementation for a government-linked road construction client - requirements, design, deployment, testing, training, and support after go-live.
- Applied Agile or Waterfall depending on what each client actually needed, keeping projects on scope, on budget, and on time.
- Ran Proof-of-Concept demos for prospective clients ahead of contract, digging into what they actually needed before scoping a solution around it.
- Built direct relationships with clients during the sales cycle, staying engaged from the first conversation through to project handoff.

IT Manager - Safwa Food (Dairy Queen Franchise)

Riyadh, Saudi Arabia | Jan 2017 - Nov 2019

- Owned IT operations and vendor relationships across 31 restaurant branches, setting technology direction under U.S. franchise standards.
- Migrated core Oracle systems from on-premises to Oracle Cloud without disrupting day-to-day operations.
- Kept POS, Kitchen Display Systems, inventory, and recipe management running reliably across every branch, tying them into the wider ERP to cut down on manual reconciliation.
- Designed infrastructure built to handle growth, then worked directly with operations teams to keep systems up through peak hours without interruption.

Assistant IT Manager - Safwa Food (Dairy Queen Franchise)

Riyadh, Saudi Arabia | Jan 2015 - Dec 2016

- Took on IT support across 30+ branch locations ahead of stepping into the full IT Manager role - infrastructure, ERP, and LMS operations, plus mentoring junior staff.
- Started building out the executive Power BI reporting that leadership relied on for visibility.

Earlier Career

System Administrator - Safwa Food (Dairy Queen Franchise) | *Riyadh, Saudi Arabia | Feb 2012 - Dec 2014*

System Administrator - SBS / ZEN | *Amman, Jordan | 2009 - 2011*

Technical Support Engineer - MSID | *Amman, Jordan | 2009 - 2011*

Key Projects

- Enterprise Digital Transformation - process redesign, service digitization, and workflow automation across multiple business units, aimed at cutting operational drag rather than just adding new tools.
- Business Intelligence & Executive Analytics - a Power BI layer leadership actually opens every week to track KPIs and make faster calls.
- Enterprise Infrastructure Modernization - rebuilt the backbone across servers, storage, virtualization, cloud, and networking for better uptime, scale, and continuity across sites.
- Oracle ERP Ownership - owned Oracle EBS modules end to end (procurement, financials-adjacent workflows), backed by Oracle R12 (IMF Systems & Procurement) certification.
- AI-Powered ITSM - architected an AI-assisted service desk concept: WhatsApp/web intake, automatic ticket classification, asset correlation, and explainable recommendations instead of a black box.

Education & Certifications

- Bachelor's Degree in Science - Open University, United Kingdom, 2010
- Bachelor's Degree in Information Technology and Computing - Open University, Jordan, 2009
- Continuing Education: Master of Cybersecurity - currently in progress (not yet completed)
- ITIL Foundation | PMP & PMI-RMP Training | Odoo Functional Consultant (v16) | AWS Cloud (EC2) | VMware Infrastructure | Sophos Firewall Administration | Oracle R12 | Cisco Networking Professional | Windows Server 2019 | Data Analytics Diploma (Power BI, Tableau, SQL, Python, Excel) | Lean Six Sigma White Belt

Languages

Arabic: Native | English: Professional Working Proficiency